

Jacob Herbstman

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Education

University of Chicago

PH.D. IN PUBLIC POLICY

Chicago, IL

2024-

University of California, Davis

B.A. ECONOMICS AND STATISTICS

- Minor in Mathematics
- Graduated with Highest Honors in Economics and Honors in Statistics

Davis, CA

2018 - 2022

Professional Experience

2022-2024 **Research Assistant, Macroeconomics Team**, Federal Reserve Bank of Chicago

2021 **Economic Research Intern, Division of International Finance**, Federal Reserve Board of Governors

Research

WORKING PAPERS

Informal Regulation and Housing Supply: Evidence from Chicago's Aldermanic Privilege

Conferences: 20th North American Meeting of the Urban Economics Association (Chicago); Notre Dame Housing Economics Research Conference

How Demand for New Skills Affects Wage Inequality: The Case of Software Programmers (with Gustavo de Souza and Jack Mannion) Chicago Fed Working Paper #2024-19

OTHER WRITING

Persistently Pessimistic: Consumer and Small Business Sentiment After the Covid Recession (with Scott Brave) Chicago Fed Letter #490, 2023

Media Coverage: 2024 CEA Report, Reuters

Awards, Fellowships, & Grants

2026 **Public Economics Initiative Award — "Regulatory Uncertainty, Developer Entry, and Housing Supply: Evidence from Chicago's Aldermanic Privilege"** Becker Friedman Institute

2025 **Mansueto Institute Urban Doctoral Fellow** University of Chicago

2023 **Economics Pre-Graduate Fellow** Duke University

2022 **Highest Honors** University of California, Davis Economics Department

Honors University of California, Davis Statistics Department

Department Citation University of California, Davis Economics Department

Department Citation University of California, Davis Statistics Department

Department Service Citation University of California, Davis Statistics Department

Phi Beta Kappa University of California, Davis

2020 **Michael Dearing Research Fellowship for Economic Research** University of California, Davis

Teaching Experience

UChicago Harris Head TA, Statistics for Data Analysis I (Masters level); Fall 2025
UChicago Harris Head TA, Statistics for Data Analysis II: Regressions (Masters level); Winter 2026

Research Experience

Federal Reserve Bank of Chicago

RESEARCH ASSISTANT, MACROECONOMICS 2022-2024

Federal Reserve Board of Governors

ECONOMIC RESEARCH INTERN, DIVISION OF INTERNATIONAL FINANCE 2021

University of California, Davis

PROFS. GIOVANNI PERI, MARIANNE BITLER, GREGORY CLARK, AND KATHERINE ERIKSSON 2020-2022

Relevant Skills

- Programming: expert in R, advanced in Stata, MATLAB, intermediate in python, git, RATS, ArcGIS
- Research skills: Data construction and cleaning, data pipeline engineering, machine learning, advanced econometrics, mathematical modeling, statistical simulation, Bayesian statistics, web scraping